We can also take a custom snapshot of a few indexes, rather than all the data as we just did. Attaching a request body to listing 14.5 specifies a set of indexes: say, all movies and all reviews.

Listing 14.6 Creating snapshots with specific indexes

```
PUT _snapshot/es_cluster_snapshot_repository/custom_prod_snapshots
{
  "indices": ["*movies*","*reviews*"]
}
```

Backs up all movies and review-related indexes

The `indices` attribute takes a string or array of strings representing the set of specific indexes we want to back up. In our example, we back up any index with a `glob` pattern of `*movies*` and `*reviews*`. By default, all the indexes and data streams are included ([*]) if we don't specify what we want to back up. To omit some, we can use the pattern with a minus sign (or dash), like this: `-*.old`. This pattern, in our case, omits all indexes ending with `.old`.

We can also attach user-defined properties in a `metadata` attribute. Say, for example, we want to note the incident details of a user's request when taking the snapshot. The following listing shows this as a query.

Listing 14.7 Adding custom details to the snapshot

```
PUT _snapshot/es_cluster_snapshot_repository/prod_snapshots_with_metadata
{
  "indices": ["*movies*","*reviews*", "-*.old"],
  "metadata":{
    "reason":"user request",
    "incident_id":"ID12345",
    "user":"mkonda"
  }
}
```

Includes or excludes these indexes in the snapshot

Defines the block of custom information under the metadata object

We enhance the list of indexes by removing "old" indexes as part of the snapshot process. We also add metadata with the user request information, and we can create as many details as possible in this object. The final step in the lifecycle of Elasticsearch's snapshot and restore functionality is to restore the snapshots, as we discuss in the next section.

14.4.4 Restoring snapshots

Restoring a snapshot is relatively straightforward. All we need to do is to invoke `_restore` on the `_snapshot` API.

Listing 14.8 Restoring data from a snapshot

```
PUT _snapshot/es_cluster_snapshot_repository/custom_prod_snapshots/_restore
```